

Market profile for consumer products

Worksheet

What is the profile of your target market? What is the buying behaviour of your customers? Decide which of the following categories are relevant for your business and make a few notes. Add an idea of your own at the end. Then discuss your ideas.

- **Gender** Male/Female. Who is the end-user? Who is the decision-maker?
- **Socio-economic group** What social class do your consumers belong to? What is the income of your target customer? Are your products up-market, mid-market or down-market? The following factors may be of interest: rank/position at work, type of work, number of people supervised, size of organization, qualifications.
- **Occupation** This is usually considered as a part of socio-economic group, but sometimes a market can be identified with an occupational sector, e.g. teachers, doctors, engineers etc. Is this true for your market?
- **Life cycle** Can you categorize your consumers according to age/stage in life? How does this influence their buying behavior? One set of categories used in marketing is: *bachelor* (young, single, living away from home); *newly married couple* (young, no children); *full nest I, II and III* (couple with children at different ages); *empty nest I* (older married couples, no children at home); *empty nest II* (older couple, retired); *solitary survivor* (in labour force or retired)
- **Children in household** The presence of children in a household affects disposable income, lifestyle, attitudes, consumption patterns etc. Is this important in your market?
- **Home ownership** Owning a home results in specific needs and responsibilities. Is this important for your customers?
- **Lifestyle** Is the lifestyle of your target consumer important? Consider: activities (hobbies, clubs, entertainment), interests (home, food, fashion), opinions (politics, economics, education).
- **Location** Urban, suburban, rural etc.
- **Personal financial management** The consumer's approach to credit and money generally. Is this important in your business?
- **Culture** National, ethnic and 'peer group' (for example teenagers being influenced by other teenagers). Does culture affect the buying behavior of your customers?
- **Psychological needs of consumers** One way to classify a market is based on the needs and motivations of different consumers. There are four consumer types: 1. *Mainstreamers* (who are conventional people with a need for security); 2. *Aspirers* (the typical 'yuppie' – they are trying to achieve something in life and need status symbols and the respect of others); 3. *Succeeders* (who have already achieved success and need to be in control of everything); 4. *Reformers* (who want to influence society and need to feel they are doing good – they also need intellectual satisfaction). Is this classification useful in identifying your target market?
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